

Interviewer: So thanks again for participating in it. It's uhm you know, it's a research study being done like here, Brazil, Netherlands, other places at the same time. We're just trying to basically see your experience and perspective to see like what your relationship experience could possibly bring for the project. So yeah, we'll just start with like the basic questions. So. So how old are you?

Speaker: I am [16-20].

Interviewer: And then how long have you and your partner been together?

Speaker: [11-15] months. Gonna be [11-15] by the end of this one.

Interviewer: Okay, and then no kids, right?

Speaker: No kids. **laughs**

Interviewer: Okay. And who lives in your household?

Speaker: My [1-5] sisters and my [1-5] parents.

Interviewer: And then uhm what's your main source of income?

Speaker: Like, who supports me or like.

Interviewer: It could be either or. So it could be like, what is your main source of income is like your parents? Or if you have a current job or both, Whatever you want to answer.

Speaker: I guess my job, that's my main source of income.

Interviewer: And then how would you like us to address your partner? Like partner, girlfriend?

Speaker: Girlfriend, partner.

Interviewer: All right. So you get to talk about her for a little bit.

Speaker: Okay.

Interviewer: So can you tell me about your, your love story? How you guys got ended up together or anything?

Speaker: It's funny. It's funny because she's been liking me for a very long time. I think she said since, like, [grade level]. But I was very much like in my own world in [grade level]. So I don't really pay much attention to any of that. And she swears she emailed me about it, but I don't remember. So that was kind of like our first interaction when it came to that. But we didn't really start like talking or anything until when was it? I think like my I think I hit her up like my [year level], I think. But that was just kind of like, "yo, like, was that you that walked into ? And then we texted for a little and then we stopped. But then it was when she won the homecoming that I like was like, you know, texting her. And then I was like, If you win, like, I have to wear the crown. And she's like, okay. And it was like 10 p.m.. And I was just like, chilling. You know, you don't expect to get pulled up by 10 p.m. and we're just texting. And I was like, pull up right now. And she was like, Okay. And she actually did. And so it was a

shock for me. I was like, Who the heck's pulling up to my house at 10 p.m.? So I was like the first time we ever talked in person. Like, obviously we'd seen each other around school in substance is a small town, but that was like the first time we like actually talk and stuff. She let me wear the crown and then just kind of took off from there. We were just like talking and she'd come over to my house like almost every other night or so. But like we wouldn't come to my house. We just chill in her car. And then that grew into like, maybe going out together at lunch and then, you know, the rest is kind of history.

Interviewer: And like you said, [11-15] months now.

Speaker: [11-15] months.

Interviewer: So then how would you compare the quality of your relationship compared to like the relationship you have with, like, your friends? Like, how do you differentiate?

Speaker: I think it's a lot more intimate. You know, like, I feel like I can talk to her about other things. Like, I definitely open up to her a lot more about like how I feel about, like, what's going on at home and just like, kind of like my everyday things. Because when I hang out with my friends, it's just kind of like big events like, Oh, I got this job or like this happen. You know kind of just like funny, like dumb interactions. But with her it's more of like the nitty gritty, like, Oh, I stole my taco today. It hurts, like for, you know, ex reason or whatever. So I think it's a lot more like I have that person to go to, even if nobody wants to listen to it.

Interviewer: Okay. So is it okay if we ask how many romantic partners you've had in the past before this relationship?

Speaker: Yeah. Let me just close my window. Cause somebody's cutting the grass, it's loud. Sorry, what was the question?

Interviewer: If we could ask how many romantic partners you've had before, so, like, how many relationships you've been on before.

Speaker: I've been in [1-5] official relationship and the other two were like talking slash kind of exclusive, but not, you know. So I guess [1-5] in total.

Interviewer: The [1-5] total, but one was like.

Speaker: Official official for a while.

Interviewer: Okay, so how would you compare the quality of those past relationships compared to the one right now?

Speaker: Not as good as the one that I have now. Like there was a lot of things that were missing or, you know, it was just like one person was a lot more into it than the other. So I think now it's a lot more. I feel like maybe because we've like matured as people that we feel like, you know, we kind of got a grasp of it, but it definitely feels secure. Like I remember or like I think it was like our first date. I was just driving and I told her, like straight up, I was like, I don't feel like you're in the car. And like, I didn't mean it like, a really weird way, but I was just like, it just feels like I'm alone. And that was like, kind of me telling her that, like, I felt, like, just comfortable around her. And when I was with the other people or, you know, just anyone, I kind of feel like, you know, there's always that presence I have to, like, tend to or, you know, just have to see, like, what's going on with that.

Interviewer: So we felt like a little bit more pressure maybe.

Speaker: Yeah, like a little bit more pressure because there was always like something like that was not okay or there was something that somebody was trying to achieve somewhere.

Interviewer: Okay. And then for you personally, what makes a relationship like high quality?

Speaker: I think communication is the number one thing because, I mean, nobody's perfect, so nobody can like, fit everybody's needs. So I feel like just being able to communicate that and having the other person like, actually listen, understand, and, you know, like maybe after you communicate it, they might not even be able to, like, fulfill those needs. But as long as they, like, acknowledge it and find at least try to find a way to fulfill that. I feel like that's kind of like the key part of a relationship.

Interviewer: So how would you, um, like, how would you describe a relationship like, or something that makes a relationship low quality?

Speaker: Pettiness, which I feel like also kind of ties into, like lack of communication. It's always like, oh, like he should have known that or, you know, maybe she shouldn't have done that. But they never, like, actually vocalize that stuff. So I feel like that's kind of like the heart of where bad relationships come from. Because, you know, there's like cheating and stuff like that. But it usually all comes down to like the rooted like something was missing in the relationship or something wasn't talked about. So I feel like pettiness was something that kind of a lot of people tend to do, and it leads to missing that part of a relationship.

Interviewer: So would you say in this relationship you use that communication is high and the pettiness is low.

Speaker: Yeah, I would. I mean, sure, we both, you know, kind of get like our petty I mean, our petty, you know, situations here and there. But I like to say that we communicate. I know. Definitely. Like, if she says something that, like, doesn't sit right with me, I might not bring it up right away, but like, a couple of days, I'll be like, hey, like, this happened earlier and I didn't like it. And she definitely does it to me sometimes. Like it's some insensitive things, but, but yeah, I think our communication is pretty good.

Interviewer: Okay, so for you, what's the most important things in a relationship?

Speaker: Like the most important things. I think just being able to be there for the person, I think that's like the main one. Especially right now since like we're kind of doing like this, like long distance, middle distance thing. Like, I can't expect her to, like, throw money at me or like, do other like, you know, these other things that, you know, people in relationships usually expect. But I can like, at least count at her to at least be there for me. So I think that's one of the most important things. And like, even like, you know, like later on, like in marriage and even when you're like, you see the person every day, as long as you're you're present in not just like physically, but also like emotionally for them. I feel like that's very important in a relationship.

Interviewer: And then why would you say that? Like, why do you think it's so important for you?

Speaker: I just feel like this is like in a relationship. The whole point is like to not go through life alone is not like to be able to have someone to lean on or just be able to, like, live life with another person being there to share, you know, the experience of life with you. So I feel like for myself, it's very important because like just my family, like we, we tend to like emotionally support each other a lot. So like that kind of grew into like what I look for in a relationship. And so that's is kind of what I like about kind. I've been looking for like, I really care like if you're pretty or you know how to cook or whatever. Like, I don't care about that stuff as long as you, you know how to, like, listen to me and be there for me when I need you. I feel like that pretty much completes that.

Interviewer: Okay, This question can be tricky to answer because I feel like it's like. So, like broad. But for you, what is love?

Speaker: Let me think about it.

Interviewer: Yeah.

Speaker: I think it's the like. The feeling of. Like I said, like, kind of like, not feeling that somebody there like that the person has become a part of who you are and not like just in a physical or emotional sense, just kind of like being able to integrate yourself 100% and accept that they're a part of your life and accept that you're a part of theirs as well. And that like kind of ties into, you know, being there emotionally, being able to communicate with them and just having them kind of like as family in a way. I feel like that's a very I feel like that's a core meaning of love, you know, being able to connect with someone on a deeper level than just physically and emotionally. It's kind of more of like a spiritual thing.

Interviewer: Okay. Okay. And so how important is love in a relationship?

Speaker: I feel like it's very important because love is kind of like the way we base everything off of, you know, like, oh, I just don't love, you know, more than people think. Like, that's it. But I feel like it's something that comes and goes because I feel like you're not constantly in, like, deep in love with someone, you know, like you might lose, like some love for someone. I know myself. I'm like, sometimes I friggin hate my sisters, you know? But, like, you know, but it's just like I feel like love comes and goes because it's a feeling at the end of the day, it's not really like something that is constant. So I think it's very important to be able to experience a love with someone. But I feel like it's something that you need to work towards and accept that it's not always going to be like. 110% every second of your life. It's going to there's going to be ups and downs.

Interviewer: So how do you know that your partner loves you?

Speaker: That's weird. And I feel like.

Interviewer: *laughs*

Speaker: Because I, I don't, I feel like people know me a lot more than I know myself. And you know how like, there's, like, oh, like, what's your love language and stuff like that? I myself haven't figured it out. So I kind of just go with the flow and then whatever, you know, make me feel good. I'm like, okay, nice. But definitely with [Name] in this instance, I feel like she she makes me feel loved in the way that, like, she talks to me and stuff like that. I feel like words from words of affection from her kind of hit home just because she she doesn't say it like a lot. A lot. Because I feel like when they when they tell me way too much attention

to tune it out. But she's just like that perfect amount to where they should be like, Oh, I love you. And like, that'll, you know, make me feel a little bit loved. Or sometimes she goes out of her way to, you know, maybe send me a picture of her face, you know, like during the day. And then, you know, I'm like, having a really rough day or she's just like, she just kind of there for me when I'm like in my ups and downs. So that's kind of how she makes me feel, you know, really loved.

Interviewer: So it's like. Like the communication thing you had mentioned earlier, right?

Speaker: Mm hmm. Yeah. Just being able to be there.

Interviewer: Okay, So we're going to get into the conflicts. So what would you say are challenges in your relationship?

Speaker: I feel like definitely the distance that we are in this because, you know, when you're physically there with someone, you're able to communicate a lot better. And I'm personally terrible at texting. Like, I tend to lag a lot. And I know she doesn't necessarily like it. And then I'm actually really bad at spelling and putting words together. So she's kind of like always, like trying to figure out a puzzle when I text. So I feel like that kind of bumps into, like, the communication. So I feel like that's one of the the main thing that's kind of like hurting us. But I feel like we've managed to find ways through it, like we face time here and there and whatnot, so.

Interviewer: So besides the distance, you don't really feel like there's any other conflicts.

Speaker: Not that I know of 110%. Maybe it will come up later, but yeah, I feel like that's one of them.

Interviewer: Do you and your girlfriend ever, like, get into arguments? Do you guys ever fight?

Speaker: Um, I don't necessarily say we like, fought, yet. But we've definitely had, like, disagreements. But you tend to just be like, little minor things. Like, I remember one time she told her friend something about, like, my college floor or something, and I didn't really sit right with me, but I didn't like I didn't really know how she meant it. But I got, you know, a little hurt. And so I brought it up to her. But it was just kind of like that and like that. And she's like, I'm sorry. And then also, like, she'll say some things sometimes or I'll say some things, and then she'll come and tell me like, Oh, I didn't like what you said there. So I feel like that's also kind of the thing, you know, just but I feel like that's just that just comes with, you know, being with someone else. And people say things here and they're talking about conflicts. There was one I had a friend in college that made her not too secure. And so that was like kind of one of our bigger conflicts that happened, you know, just kind of deal with that because I tend to lean a lot more to women when it comes to making friends. And I don't know why. I just feel like I can't make friends with guys. And so I tend to have a lot of like girlfriends. And I don't think she necessarily loves that. And so that was one of the conflicts that we had. But we talked about it and we kind of went over like different things and was like, Oh, well, I obviously can't like just cut off all my friends, but we went over, you know, how to overcome that and we've talked about it. So I'm trying to keep up my end of the of the deal and she'll keep her in.

Interviewer: So yeah.

Speaker: We're working on that.

Interviewer: Okay. I'm sorry. There's like, a little airplanes that always fly by. So the conflicts that come from, like, the long distance or the texting that you said. And what you just mentioned right now. Like, how often would you say that, like those little bumps in the road happen?

Speaker: Not too often. I mean, when the friend thing was like, very new, it came up once and then I kind of just waited for the problem to go away. But that was a bet on my part because obviously it's not going to go away if I don't do anything about it. So it came up, like I want to say, like [1-5] month and a half later. But since then we haven't really talked about that since it kind of ceased being a problem. But like the other stuff, I usually it comes up maybe like once every [1-5] months, but that's usually when we're like really busy, like I'll be in midterm season, so I won't be able to answer a lot. Or I remember during spring break, I was working on my truck a lot and I usually I'm not on my phone when I'm working on my car, so I wouldn't answer her for like 6 hours and she was like right down the road. So she was like, Yo, I kind of feel a little ignored that Like, we're actually like, close and you're not, you know, making time for me. So, yeah, I mean, it comes up here and there, but not like reoccurring where you're like, Well, it happens a lot.

Interviewer: Okay. So aside from you guys kind of like taking your time to talk about it and everything, what are other ways that you guys maintain your relationship?

Speaker: I feel like we make time for each other and. Not just like through texting or based on whatever. Like sometimes I'll go to [Location] and I've surprised her once and she's surprised me coming to [Location] once. So it's just kind of giving us giving each other like those, like little surprises. Or sometimes I'll just like, oh, like, let's go out and eat and then I'll buy her like, really nice food or whatever, you know, just kind of like, give each other things to make each other feel good, you know, even like when nothing is bad or, you know, when things are good, just to let them know that, like, we're still thinking about them and stuff like that. Sometimes I'll just send her some money so she can go buy herself some food when she's having a bad day and stuff. So I feel like that's kind of a way that we, you know, keep our relationship strong even though we can, like, necessarily talk or see each other too much.

Interviewer: Okay, so. Would you say that your relationship is good for you?

Speaker: Yes, I think our relationship is really good for me.

Interviewer: Would you like to share why?

Speaker: I feel like she makes me a better person just because I feel like I'm a bit of an asshole when I'm not with anyone, just because I tend to just care about myself. And she is she's a very like she thinks a lot about what other people feel, and she's just like she hates making people feel bad. And I feel like she pushes that on me and I feel like that makes me a better person just because if I were single, I'd be like, Yo, I'm college, I'm doing what I want, you know? But she'll be more of like, you know, maybe, you know, maybe don't do that because, you know, maybe your teacher will get mad or maybe your roommate won't like that. So she definitely keeps me in check with that. But she also, like, keeps me in check when it comes to, like, homework and stuff. Like she. I feel like not to make it seem like she's my mother or anything, but like she keeps me in check when I go towards things that I probably shouldn't be doing, like not doing my homework and stuff like that. Not that I

necessarily like need it, but just having that like person to just be like, you know, maybe that's not the best idea for you. Just kind of like made me a better person overall. So I do think that, you know, being with her is very good.

Interviewer: So by making you feel like a better person is a good day to day thing. Like, even like in terms of like reaching your goals and stuff like that?

Speaker: Yes, most definitely. You want me to elaborate on that?

Interviewer: Yeah, yeah, yeah.

Speaker: I was going to say, Yeah, I feel like on a day to day. Like she makes me a better person. Like, sometimes she doesn't have to say anything. It's just things that she's like. I've already told me before. Sometimes I'll be like, What would she do in a situation like this? And so I feel like that that I've kind of carried on and, like, brought onto my myself to make myself a better person. From what I've seen from her. So. Yeah.

Interviewer: The. I think you talked about this a little bit already in some of your answers, but did the relationship change you? And if it did, you could talk a little bit more about like how.

Speaker: It really did right before I got with her. I was in, like, a very bad depressive state, you know, because, like, my grandpa had just died and my sisters both left and I was like, one of those people that I was with was like, not the best person. Very toxic, manipulative. But like, as soon as I had just gotten out of, like, the relationship with her, it was kind of like going up. And that's when things with her started getting a little bit better. Well, lately, like year when I started to talk to her and stuff like that, and I feel like she was someone that, like, helped pull me out of that just because, like, I'm sure you know how it is like being in a household and not being able to like to tell people about how you feel. And then having my sisters like, you know, right across the hall to, you know, talk to them. So I just felt kind of alone. And then just having her to kind of lean on like helped me a lot. So I feel like from where I started to where I am now, I was in a really bad place when we first started the relationship, and she pulled me out of that hole. And I want to say like, I got to a point where I was like, content. I was back to like, how I was before I was depressed with her, but I felt like I was just going to stop there, you know, just be like back to my normal self. But I've definitely felt a lot better than how I was before. I feel like I've grown a lot and I'm definitely a lot happier now than I was [1-5] years ago.

Interviewer: Nice. That's good to hear. Okay, So what about your partner? So did she change during the relationship? So, um, you know. Yeah. No, no, no. Because I don't know if that was a little hard to understand.

Speaker: No, no, it makes sense. I feel like she's, like, during, like, the span of the relationship of who she was towards me or, like, in general.

Interviewer: Uhm, how are you feel like answering it if I think maybe about herself, if you notice some changes of her and like, her person. Identity was or it is her.

Speaker: Uhm, identity was. I don't I can't really say 100% just because, you know, like when you're first dating someone you don't really like know who they are. But when it came to, you know, like, between us, too, I feel like she changed a lot because when we first started talking, she was very nervous, very closed off. Um, I feel like that's just how she is,

naturally just doesn't really open up to a lot of people. But once, like, I started, you know, breaking down wall by wall, I start to get nuts and like know who she really was not feel like my at least my aspect of her, like my vision of her changed a lot throughout the relationship because I was able to learn a lot more about like where she came from, her life and everything. And I feel like that kind of opened my eyes to who she really was in terms of like herself, identity. I could think of one thing is she was very like. Like she was very much of a recluse. Like, she wouldn't really want to talk to people unless she really had to. Not that she was like a loner or anything, but she was like very much like, I have my three core friends and like, I'm not going to go anywhere from like, away from that. And I'm like, the complete opposite. I'll talk to God, I'll talk to strangers if I if I can. And so just I feel like her just having to, like, go through that experience of, like, you know, maybe we were walking down the street and I talked to, like, some random person and her just being there. I feel like it opened her a lot more to, you know, talking to other people. And I feel like she feels a lot more comfortable talking to, you know, bigger groups of people now.

Interviewer: Up. So this one's going back to you. So. Like I said, you had already explained it a little bit, but I was just asking again. Is the person you were before the relationship, the same as the person you are now.

Speaker: No. Most definitely. Yeah. I feel like before I started dating her, before I got until, like, my little depressive episode, I was very much like me first. Very. You know, I don't care what other people think. And then after, you know, we started dating and everything, I think a lot more about what other people feel and ways to help other people when before I don't think I'd really look into, you know, ways to like maybe like not to say I completely disregard other people's feelings, but I feel like I'm a lot more aware of it. And I'm actually like, looking into like, helping other people, which are things that I probably wouldn't have really thought about.

Interviewer: And then in regards of her, you said that maybe she's like a little bit less shy now or a little bit more open to, to like bigger groups of people?

Speaker: Yeah, most definitely. Because my friend group is like full, but I think we have like 12 people in it. And before she only had like [1-5] or [1-5] people that she would go to as friends. And now, like she kind of became part of our whole friend group and like, she'll go hang out with them without me and stuff. So.

Interviewer: Okay, so this next one is about just relationship safety. So it's safety in terms of like being able to open up to your partner about your thoughts, like your identity without, like being like scared that she'll judge you or something. And then the expectation that, like the other will, like, offer comfort in caring times of, like, distress or anything. It could, you could answer in terms of like physical safety or emotional safety or like both if you want to. So, yeah. So do you feel safe in the relationship?

Speaker: Um, I do. I do. I mean, physically, I don't think I have anything to be worried about. But when it comes to, like, emotionally and stuff like that, I feel like. I feel like I'm safe, but I feel like sometimes I get into my own head. But that just might be like my own insecurities of like, Oh, like, what if I tell her that and she doesn't like how I think or whatever? But that's not necessarily because I don't feel safe going to her, but I feel like that's just because I double guessed everything that I say. But for the most part, when it comes to like, you know, actually expressing my emotions and telling me things like that, I'm definitely very secure when it comes to talking to her.

Interviewer: These are some examples of like that feeling of safety, just like being able to talk to her about like, anything.

Speaker: Yeah, Yeah. Obviously there's some things that are like a little bit harder to talk about just because, you know, there's some things that you don't really want to, you know, just tell anyone.

Interviewer: Yeah.

Speaker: So I feel like definitely there is some like level of, like insecurity, but I feel like that just comes with when you have hard conversations. But for the most part, like when it comes to just like, Oh, I feel crappy today or anything like that, I'm usually not someone to verbalize like, Oh, I had a bad day. Even my roommates or anyone. They tend to just like put on a fake smile and everything. So I feel very comfortable being able to like, you know, put a frown. You know, when I when I when I am sad.

Interviewer: And then what would be some examples of you feeling like unsafe in a relationship?

Speaker: Um. I feel like maybe just because I get a little insecure sometimes, it's just how I. How I feel like. At times. Sometimes I feel like if I give too much affection, I might scare her off. You know, I'm sorry. Yeah, I feel like that's one of the things. I feel like that's my main thing. You know, I just feel like sometimes I'll say something and it'll, you know, click something in her in her brain that she'll be like, Oh, maybe not. And maybe I don't want to be with this guy. But when it comes to, like, having hard conversations about, like, you know, life and family and stuff, I'm okay with that is just kind of. I don't want to say something wrong. Per se.

Interviewer: Mm hmm. Yeah. Okay. See if I can, because I'm going to have to show you something real quick. Yes. So it's likert scale and can you see one of those before.

Speaker: Our.

Interviewer: Like it scale the ones like, like if you ever take quizzes on like online, like on [Website] or anything and it tells you like one to like whatever and it's like. And so it's kind of like that.

Speaker: Are you going to share your screen.

Interviewer: Is it? Mm hmm. Okay. Can you see it? Can you see the one to nine?

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: Okay. So from 1 to 9. Um, if I were to ask, my partner, usually listen to me, what would be your answer?

Speaker: I would say nine.

Interviewer: Okay. And then if I were to ask if your partner is responsive to your needs, what would be your answer?

Speaker: Um, I'd say an eight.

Interviewer: eight.

Interviewer: Okay. So when you answered nine to the one where you feel like she really listens to you, can you give some examples of why you chose the nine and not like the one or something?

Speaker: Um, well, just cause I feel like I'll beat her, I'll go to her. I'm like, Oh, I need to talk to you. And she'll drop everything, you know, stop everything. Like she'll be doing homework or anything, and she'll like, you know, she'll be ready to, to, like, hear what I have to say. And then when I do tell her, she acknowledges it. She doesn't always repeat it to me, but like, she at least lets me know that she, like, you know, understood what I said. And so I feel like that definitely makes me feel like she is definitely listening to me.

Interviewer: Okay. So for the other one, where it was that your partner is usually responsive to your needs, you answered an eight, so why an eight.

Speaker: As an eight, just because I feel like I do have some needs that are not necessarily 110% meant, but I feel like I personally don't tell her about those needs just because when those needs are met, I feel like a little bit happier because I didn't tell her like words of affection. I did not I have not told her that I like her words of affection. But I feel like because I haven't told her they feel better when I don't, when like when she does tell me, you know, just cause like, oh, she thought about it without me telling her. But I feel like I said an eight maybe just because, like, she doesn't do it as much as I would love that she did, but I definitely feel like she she does do it. I feel like if I definitely talk to her, she would, you know, go all out and, you know, make me feel 110%. But I like the the level of unfairness like i'm okay

Interviewer: Like the surprise. Yeah. Okay. So if it's cool with you, I'm going to end it really quick because I only have the 40 minute one. Okay. And then we'll just hop back on the same week in, like maybe like 2 minutes because it takes some time for the thing to save on my. Okay, same link. Um. So we're going to go into a little bit more of like a personal question. There's only two, but it's like with your consent and everything. Like, you don't have to answer it if you don't want to. Well yeah, feel free to say this is sensitive and you don't want to share. But for the research purposes, they also want to know more about your physical intimacy as a couple. So they want to know, like these days, how often do you guys like, like, hook up?

Speaker: I feel like obviously, since we're this far apart, it really. But when we were first dating, it was like almost every time we saw each other, we only saw each other, like, once every two weeks. But definitely now it's like kind of slowed down. And she kind of like, also told me that, like, it's not a priority for her and she'd rather, like, hang out and, you know, hook up. And so I was like, okay, that's perfectly fine with me. So a little bit less than how we were at the beginning of the relationship, but like, consistent.

Interviewer: Okay. And then the last one about that one. A little back to your answer. How satisfied are you with, like, your sex life?

Speaker: I am pretty satisfied, but I don't think there's, you know, anything that I necessarily am missing. She has her boundaries that I have to respect because of stuff that has happened. But I feel like once we were able to draw those lines, we were both able to like,

understand what we can and can't do. And so I feel like that kind of just being able to communicate that stuff allowed and allowed us to, you know, feel satisfied with that.

Interviewer: Nice to hear that you agree to talk about it because that could be challenging sometimes for people. Okay, so. I pull this up really quick because I'm going to have to show you another one of the likert scale. So this is the same thing. They go from. Like, not satisfied at all. Completely satisfied. Let me show you this through. Can you see it?

Speaker: Yes

Interviewer: So this one, how would you rate your satisfaction with your relationship?

Speaker: Like in total or something like that?

Interviewer: Yeah, like, how would you— Yeah. In general, like your satisfaction with your relationship. Zero bearing. Not at all satisfied to ten being completely.

Speaker: I would say like nine.

Interviewer: Nine, okay. I'm sorry. I suck at this. I got— I got a new laptop for [Event], so I don't know what I'm doing sometimes.

Speaker: What's that?

Interviewer: Hmm?

Speaker: What laptop did you get?

Interviewer: My brother got me a [Brand Name] after I had, like, a dinosaur laptop for, like, the past [6-10] years.

Speaker: Oh no. Yeah. The [Brand] are tricky at the beginning, but then once you get the hang of it.

Interviewer: Okay. So since you said your answer was a nine.

Speaker: Mm hmm.

Interviewer: Where you're satisfied? Okay, so. So nine is like pretty up there, you know, almost 100%. Do you want to go a little bit into more like why like, a nine?

Speaker: I say nine just because I feel like. I have not felt like I want to get out of the relationship at all. And I feel very comfortable, like since we started in everything. But I say ten just because it's not perfect. I feel like no relationship is perfect, so I can't rate it a ten. But yeah, I just feel like if I like if I rate it any lower, then it wouldn't do justice to how much work we put into like, you know, talking and stuff like that. So yeah, very effortless, I want to say.

Interviewer: Okay, you didn't pick ten because, like you said, you don't feel like anything is really perfect.

Speaker: Yeah.

Speaker: You really have to give that room for improvement, you know.

Interviewer: So did, did your relationship or does your relationship fulfill your expectations?

Speaker: Um, yeah, I think it far exceeds it. Just cause not to bash on my parents or anything, but, I mean, they have a really good relationship. They just never really showed me, like, how a relationship would look. Like they kind of do all their relationship stuff. Closed doors. They're more just like parents in front of us. So my relationship standards were just kind of like, Oh, yeah, just two people, you know, go get dinner and stuff like that. But now that I'm like, definitely into the relationship, I see how much like emotions go on in it and how much support is actually in a relationship and how much communication time and effort goes into it. So yeah.

Interviewer: But, only then, you thought it was kind of just like people hanging out and that's it.

Speaker: I mean, obviously there was some more to it, but I didn't I guess I just never was prepared for the feeling of, of like being able to, like, be supported by someone, just because, like, I have never really experienced what it was to be like an actual relationship that was like back and forth because all my other ones were very much either one sided or they were not good at all. And so I never got that experience of like having to be able to talk to someone who, like, genuinely, like, loves you. And you wouldn't have to be, like, worried about that person's sincerely leaving you. I mean, unless you, like, genuinely fuck up and then, you know, there's something there. But yeah, I mean, like when you're with family, it's like a different type of relationship, you know? It's just kind of like you're obligated to be my sister. But when it's somebody else that, like, doesn't know where you came from, you know, it's just kind of like they love the person that you made up, like the person that you are, basically. I feel like I wasn't prepared for that feeling so it far exceeded my expectations for.

Interviewer: Okay, so we're close to wrapping up. So then I just want to give you like a short summary of what we have so far. Um, so you said that it was very important for a relationship to have, like communication for, like each partner to make time for each other and be there for each other, not just physically, emotionally as well. One thing that would make the relationship poor is like the pettiness kind of that leads into the lack of communication. And then overall, you're pretty satisfied with your relationship and like exceeded the expectations you had going in.

Speaker: Mm hmm.

Interviewer: Yeah. Um, was that right? Or is there anything else besides that that you want to add in that to?

Speaker: No, that's pretty much right.

Interviewer: So now it's your day to notice you have some options. And if it gets too tricky, just let me know. And I could, like, share my screen so you can take a look at it. So we want to talk to you about how we handle the data as a research project. We want to be as ethically transparent as possible, and so we want to know which data sharing option you are most comfortable with. So option one is that transcript portions can be shared. None of these are going to be identified like nothing's gonna say like [Name] or anything and could be read by other researchers, that's option one. Option two, if you're more open to it, it's another option

of the whole transcript being shared. And then there's like sensitive information that could be removed that, like, maybe could pinpoint your identity. Mm hmm. Although this option is like a very minimal chance that someone who knows you can piece together the details in the transcript and narrow down like who you are. No sensitive information will be shared. Um, so you have two options. One is like the portion of transcripts, and the second one is like the whole transcript. Um, so which option would you want to do?

Speaker: I'll do the whole transcript. It's okay.

Interviewer: Okay. Well, I just want to thank you again for taking your time for this study. Like I said, it's being done in the Philippines, Brazil, Netherlands, France and here. But for the study to be successful, we also just have one more favor to ask you. It's just for you to recommend two close people in your life as nominators. We would ask those people for like additional couples that might be interested in the study, but we'll be asking them for couples that you might not really know or interact with that much just to get like a little more of an outside scope, a little bit more diverse in the study. So if you have two people in mind that you think would know like couples, that you don't really know that well.

Speaker: Like two people that are they're like, separate from each other, two people that are couples.

Interviewer: So it's the nominators. So it could be like a friend that you have that might know couples that you might not like necessarily be friends with or something.

Speaker: Yeah. I can give you some names. How do I do that to just tell you their names.

Interviewer: Um. Yeah. You can tell me right now, their names.

Speaker: One would be [Name]. And then the other one is [Name]. I feel like they would know people.

Interviewer: Yeah. Okay, So afterwards, if you could send me, like, their email or something, and then I'll send them something. And then if you can also let them know that they might hear from me, like today or tomorrow. And you could give them a scope of kind of what it is so they don't get scared going like this random person. Yeah. So, like, their job is basically just to recommend they're not like going to be interviewed or anything if they just know people that would be open to doing this study, then yeah, I think that wraps everything up basically. So yeah, I'll send you like a follow up things. Kind of just like a thank you.